

Transparency & Masks Reference

FDD 7.4 · DIGITAL
COMMUNICATIONS

NAME

DATE



Opacity

Transparency panel slider.
Lowers how see-through the
whole selected object is, from
100% (solid) to 0% (invisible).



Blending Mode

Transparency panel dropdown.
Changes how a selected
object's colors mix with
whatever is stacked beneath it
(for example, Multiply darkens,
Screen lightens).



Clipping Mask

Object > Clipping Mask > Make
(topmost shape crops
everything below it). A hard
edge only, no partial
transparency.



Opacity Mask

Drag a second object onto the
mask thumbnail in the
Transparency panel. White
areas stay visible, black
disappears, gray partially
fades, use a gradient for a
smooth fade.

Quick test: does your mask need a hard edge (clipping mask) or a gradual fade (opacity mask, usually built with a gradient)?